

Contraception

Contraception is a range of methods that couples can use to reduce the chances of pregnancy. No method of contraception is 100 percent effective. Both people in a couple have joint responsibility for the correct use of contraception.

Methods of contraception

There are two main types of contraception: barrier and hormonal. Barrier methods, including the male and female condom and the diaphragm, physically block sperm from reaching the egg. Hormonal methods, such as “the pill,” act in different ways, including stopping the ovaries from releasing eggs, or preventing sperm from making it to the egg. All contraceptives can be obtained privately and anonymously from a sexual health clinic, and some types can be purchased from pharmacies.

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◀ 230–231	Safer sex
Sexually transmitted diseases	234–237 ▶



△ **Advantages and disadvantages**
Researching the side effects, pros, and cons of each method can help teens make a decision.

Male condoms

During sex, a male condom is worn on an erect penis to provide a physical contraceptive barrier. It works by “catching” the semen so that it doesn’t enter the sexual partner. Condoms also protect against sexually transmitted diseases (STDs), including HIV.

A condom should only ever be used once. Following vaginal intercourse, the male should withdraw his penis before he loses his erection. The condom should be tied and thrown in the trash (not down the toilet). If a condom tears, it should be discarded and a new one used instead, as even the smallest tear makes it ineffective.

ALERT!

Using male condoms safely

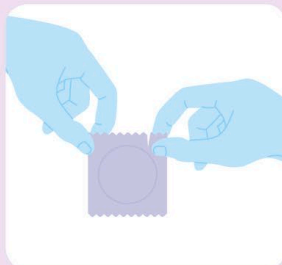
Condoms are easy to use and take effect immediately, but they need to be used properly.

- If contact occurs between the penis and vagina before a condom is used, pregnancy can still result.
- Oil-based lubricants damage the material that the condom is made from, making it likely to fail.
- Condoms have an expiration date, after which they shouldn’t be used.

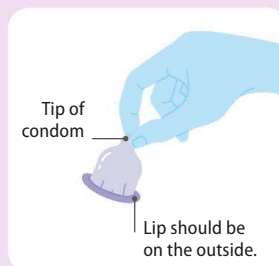
Using male condoms

To use a male condom correctly:

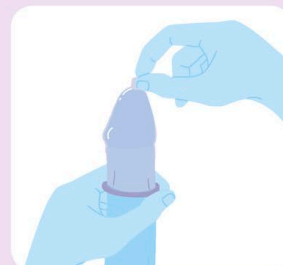
- The person needs to be aroused, because a male condom can only be used on an erect penis.
- The correct-sized condom must be used so that it fits comfortably and securely around the circumference of the erect penis without being too tight or too loose; otherwise, it can split or come off during sex.



△ To open the condom package, use fingers (not scissors) to tear down the side of the packaging.



△ Check that the condom’s lip is on the outside. Pinch the condom’s tip to prevent an air pocket.



△ Keep the tip pinched and roll the condom down the entire length of the penis. It should roll easily.